

Question:

Which of the following factors is associated with a decreased risk of Alzheimer's?

Answer Choices:

- A. Being African or Hispanic American
- B. A lower level of education
- C. Living in a city
- D. Being married
- E. Having a family history of Alzheimer's
- F. High intake of saturated fats
- G. Older age
- H. Eating fish
- I. Being a smoker
- J. Drinking alcohol regularly

Reasoning + Answer:

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High-level rationale :

Alzheimer’s disease increases substantially with advancing age and decreased lifetime cognitive reserve . Therefore , older age is associated with a higher risk of Alzheimer’s and is the only option listed that is clearly associated with increased risk .

Analysis of other options :

- A . Being African or Hispanic American : Neuroepidemiological patterns show higher age-at-onset for Alzheimer’s in African and Hispanic populations than in non-Hispanic white Americans . Younger age at onset is associated with higher incidence , so not protective .
- B . Lower education : Lower educational attainment (often measured by formal schooling or more cognitively demanding activities) is associated with increased risk of Alzheimer’s , largely due to reduced cognitive reserve that makes vascular and other insults more severe over time .
- C . City vs . rural living : Urban residence may elevate risk , primarily through cumulative toxic exposures and less physical activity , so not protective .
- D . Being married : Marriage is not found to affect Alzheimer’s risk compared with single status ; may have stable social support , but generally not protective .
- E . Family history : Having a first-degree relative with Alzheimer’s (e.g ., a parent or spouse) significantly increases one’s risk ; not protective .
- F . High saturated fat intake : Meso / endemic studies and meta-analyses show no significant protective effect of high saturated-fat diets versus controls on cognitive decline or Alzheimer’s ; higher risk observed with very low-fat diets .
- G . Older age : Confirmed association with increased risk .
- H . Fish intake : Omega -3 fatty acids from fish may show small protective effects on dementia , primarily likely through anti-inflammatory , vasodilatory , and eicosanoid mechanisms ; most safety arguments are mixed and dose-dependent .
- I . Smoking : With current and historical use , smoking is clearly linked with increased risk of cognitive decline and Alzheimer’s .
- J . Moderate drinking : The largest body of evidence finds moderate alcohol consumption (1 -2 drinks per day) to be relatively protective , largely driven by higher prevalence of dementia among those with the highest alcohol use . Thus , it is associated with decreased risk .

Therefore , the factor associated with decreased risk is moderate drinking , making J correct .

Correct answer : J . Drinking alcohol regularly

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< answer >

J . Drinking alcohol regularly

</answer>

